Glossary

innate (adj) - inborn and natural

stake (n) - risk

persistence (n) - determination

sigh (v) - emit a long, deep audible breath expressing sadness, relief or tiredness

groans (v) - complaints and grumbles

moans (v) - grieves

mess with (ph.v) - meddle or interfere with.

prankster (n) - a person who acts mischievously

A. Read the lines and answer the questions.

1. *The summer of life she's ready to see in spring.*
   She says, "Spring will come again, my dear
   Let me care for the ones who're near."

   a) What does the word summer mean here?
   b) How does she take life ?
   c) What does she mean by "spring will come again?"

2. *Strong is she in her faith and beliefs.*
   "Persistence is the key to everything," says she.

   a) What is she strong about?
   c) How does she deal with the adversities in life?

3. *Despite the sighs and groans and moans,*
   She's strong in her faith, firm in her belief!

   a) Is she complaining about the problems of life?
   b) Pick out the words that show her grit.

4. *Don't ever try to saw her pride, her self-respect.*
   She knows how to thaw you, saw you – so beware!

   a) What do the words thaw and saw mean here?
   b) What is the tone of the author?

5. *She's today's woman. Today's woman dear.*
   Love her, respect her, keep her near...

   a) Is the poet talking about the women of the previous generation?
   b) How should a woman be treated?

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